CHARACTERISTICS OF INDIGENOUS LANGUAGE REVITALIZATION INITIATIVES ON SOCIAL MEDIA THAT COULD HELP SPARK YOUNG PEOPLE'S INTEREST IN LEARNING TÉNEK

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Abstract

The main objective is to analyze initiatives and strategies for the teaching and revitalization of Indigenous languages aimed at young people, particularly through digital media. A review of literature on the teaching and revitalization of Indigenous languages through digital platforms (TikTok, Facebook, Instagram, and YouTube) was conducted using a qualitative approach with an exploratory-descriptive scope.

Introduction

Mexico has 69 national languages, including Spanish, as well as 364 linguistic variants of the 68 Indigenous languages spoken in the country.

There are 168,729 Tének speakers in Mexico. Three linguistic variants are recognized: Western, Central, and Eastern Tének. The Eastern variant is considered to be at high risk of disappearing.

Research Question

What characteristics of Indigenous language revitalization initiatives on social media could help spark young people's interest in learning Tének?

Objectives

- To identify initiatives and strategies for the teaching and revitalization of Indigenous languages through digital media and other spaces.
- To analyze which characteristics of the content used in these initiatives may foster interest in learning an Indigenous language.

Methodology

This project was carried out with the support of ChatGPT to identify relevant literature on Indigenous language teaching at both national and international levels. Several initiatives were identified, and a comparative analysis was conducted.

To achieve the research objectives, a qualitative approach with an exploratory-descriptive scope was adopted.

Results

Country	Language	Funding	Medium/Platform	Methods	Type of Content
Chile	Mapuzugun	To be verified	Facebook Instagram YouTube	Vocabulary, pronunciation, culture	Videos, images, activities
Nueva Zelanda	Máori	Māori government/organizations	Tik tok	Everyday phrases, correct pronunciation, word of the day	Short videos, Reels, Shorts
México	Náhuatl	To be investigated	Google+	Videos featuring interviews conducted by young people	Herbal medicine
México	Totonaco	To be investigated	Facebook	Oral and written use of the mother tongue	Videos, images, activities

The characteristics of the content used in Indigenous language teaching and revitalization initiatives through digital media and other settings were identified. These initiatives include community-based projects, educational initiatives, digital materials, revitalization campaigns, and projects that combine social media with in-person activities.

This analysis provides a foundation for the teaching and revitalization of the Tének language, as the author of this poster has taught her mother tongue, Tének, in different formats, including both in-person and online classes.

Conclusions

Although these initiatives do not necessarily emerge in the same way, some cases in Mexico rely on informal learning as a link between the individual and the collective.

The projects employ different strategies, including vocabulary teaching, pronunciation, everyday phrases, and subtitled interviews with older native speakers who share stories or recipes involving medicinal plants. Other projects incorporate both oral and written use of the Indigenous language. This analysis provides a foundation for the teaching and revitalization of the Tének language.

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